abilities – and really make your mark, and then to take your game to the next level. Instead, some of the young guys appear totally satisfied to be local franchise players for their entire careers.

A few of them come from tough backgrounds, where they did not have a lot of money, and they are more than happy to be earning whatever they are getting paid at Western Province. They've got some money and a little local fame, with which they're happy. Some of the guys are even getting a little thick around the middle, and that's just inexcusable in my book, and plain lazy. Look, I have my faults, but I've always worked damned hard to stay in top shape. My fitness is a big part of who I am. I've grown to love being fit, and when I can't train, I'm probably the most frustrated guy around.

I'm trying to make these guys realise that with hard work and application, they can take their natural talent and *really* make it work for them. The occasional national team call-up should not be enough. They should be working their flabby butts off to secure a place in the national team, or at least help the Cobras get into the Standard Bank Pro20 final. They then have a chance to shine at the Champions League tournament, from where they could get an IPL contract. And that's where the *real* money is.

I've also started to have a little say in my IPL team too. This past season I worked hard to up the Deccan Chargers' energy levels while we were fielding. At one post-match debriefing, after we had lost a game, coach Darren Lehmann asked us if anyone wanted to say anything. I put up my hand and said how important a little encouragement was on the field, and what a huge difference it could make: it not only lifted your teammates when they were defending a low total, but also let the batsmen know that we were the bladdy defending champs and that we were not going down without a fight.

The Indian players are generally quiet by nature. They are not very outspoken, and they tend to talk in a quiet, mellow tone of voice. But I got them to understand the value of making a noise so that your teammates could benefit. Why keep quiet when you can be offering words of encouragement … when you can keep a buzz going on the field? I say something every second ball, not only because it is a part of me, but also because I feel it's my duty to my teammates. It doesn't take much effort to say 'Come on, boys' every second or third ball. I mean, let's face it, fielding isn't the most exciting activity in the world – especially if you've been at it